ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 18: **The Book That Saved the Earth (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** a harmless children's book prevents a planned invasion	Situational irony.
2	**(a)** Had the Martians understood the book, they would have attacked.	Inversion.
3	**(c)** bathos	Bathos.
4	**(d)** Unless the Martians understood Earth, they should not attack.	Correct conditional.
5	**(d)** gently mocking	Satirical.
6	**(a)** it is a centre of knowledge misread by ignorant invaders	Symbolic.
7	**(c)** their surreal images can be misread as literal facts	Surreal.
8	**(b)** the limits of reasoning without cultural context	Context matters.
9	**(d)** a story with a hidden moral meaning	Allegory.
10	**(b)** tragic death of the hero	No tragic hero.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Satire lets the writer criticise pride and war through laughter (1) and the audience learns without feeling lectured (1).	1+1
12	That the Martians choose that book is lucky for Earth (1) and the writer accepts coincidence as a comic device (1).	1+1
13	Think-Tank's grand vocabulary and solemn tone contrast with trivial content (1) which exposes his lack of understanding (1).	1+1
14	They are universally familiar and obviously harmless (1) so the Martians' solemn reading is funnier and exposes misinterpretation (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The audience knows the book is harmless, while the Martians believe it is menacing. This gap creates laughter and sympathy. We enjoy the Martians' errors and feel superior and relieved.	1+1+1
16	Think-Tank is exaggerated as pompous and certain. The exaggeration makes his mistakes more vivid. It turns him into a comic type.	1+1+1
17	The comic tone and the moral would vanish. The ironic title would not fit. The play would become a tragedy.	1+1+1
	OR: The Martians plan attack without understanding the target. Their hierarchy is rigid and pompous. The play suggests that militarism relies on assumptions and ego.	1+1+1
18	The library holds humankind's knowledge, which the Martians cannot read. Their failure to use it shows that ignorance is the real enemy. The library represents the cure.	1+1+1
	OR: By reducing the invaders to bumbling, pompous figures. By using nursery rhymes as the crisis. By ending with friendship instead of war.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Thesis (1). Martians' ignorance (1). Possible consequences (1). Luck rather than wisdom saves Earth (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Misunderstanding in diplomacy (1). Propaganda and fear (1). Need for dialogue (1). Limits of comparison (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Historian's opening (1). Martians' scenes (1). Climactic decision (1). Historian's close (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1

	OR: Pomp (1). Overconfidence (1). Misreading (1). Comic speech (1). Role in satire (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling it a serious play; it is a **humorous science-fiction play** by Claire Boiko, set in the future with Martians and Earthlings.
- Mixing the characters: **Think-Tank** (Martian chief), **Noodle**, Captain Omega, Lieutenant Iota and Sergeant Oop.
- Saying the book was a weapon; it was a book of **nursery rhymes (Mother Goose)** that the Martians misread as military secrets.
- Missing the irony: a simple book of *nursery rhymes* saved the planet because the Martians misunderstood it.
- Forgetting the setting: Probe One lands in the **Centerville Public Library** on Earth and the crew studies books.
- Writing the play summary in dialogue form; use *simple present tense* and third person.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 18: **The Book That Saved the Earth (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** the audience knowing the rhymes are harmless	Audience knowledge.
2	**(c)** they would see the rhymes as harmless and might attack	Counterfactual.
3	**(b)** the Martians' retreat	Ignorance leads to fear.
4	**(c)** add comic detachment and reassure the audience	Comic frame.
5	**(a)** misinformation and its effects on decisions	Modern relevance.
6	**(d)** overconfident	Overconfident.
7	**(c)** informed understanding is the basis of peace	Moral.
8	**(a)** overconfidence without understanding	Comic flaw.
9	**(c)** the Martians' plan to invade without understanding	Rashness.
10	**(c)** its humour relies on simple mockery and a convenient coincidence	Critique.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Jokes and silly reasoning keep the mood light (1) while the final remarks quietly point out the moral on peace and knowledge (1).	1+1
12	It suggests peace can come from a lucky error (1) which may undervalue the hard work of real diplomacy (1).	1+1
13	Fear of the unknown makes the Martians retreat (1) and shows that fear arises from ignorance more than from real danger (1).	1+1
14	They restore a calm perspective (1) and show that the later friendship of the planets was a consequence (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The Historian presents the story as a bygone event. This reassures us that all ended well and allows ironic comment. It also adds a layer of reflection on how history is told.	1+1+1
16	It is a comedy on the surface. Beneath, it warns about hasty war decisions and misinformation. The humour makes the warning accessible.	1+1+1
17	Noodle and the crew follow Think-Tank's reading even when doubtful. No one questions the absurd logic. The play suggests that rigid hierarchy hides foolishness.	1+1+1
	OR: The Martians judge Earth by a single book. They cannot understand idioms, humour or imagination. The play shows how little we know of others without effort.	1+1+1
18	The same words can be understood differently. The Martians read nursery rhymes literally and politically. The plot turns on interpretation.	1+1+1
	OR: It encourages reading and critical thinking. It teaches the value of context and knowledge. Its humour makes learning enjoyable.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction (1). The Martians' failure (1). Misinformation today (1). Role of books and critical reading (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Grand preparations (1). Silly cause of retreat (1). Contrast (1). Humour (1). Effect on theme (1).	2+2+1

20	Both are science fiction (1). One comic, one tense (1). Griffin misuses knowledge; Martians lack it (1). Both warn about fear (1). Judgement (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Title and writer (1). Summary (1). Strengths (1). Weaknesses (1). Recommendation (1).	2+2+1

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 18: **The Book That Saved the Earth (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** have partial knowledge and act on it	Proverb.
2	**(a)** pompous gestures and a grave voice	Comic style.
3	**(d)** projecting one's fears onto ambiguous evidence	Projection.
4	**(a)** The play uses the Martians' errors to expose human tendencies to fear the unknown.	Analysis.
5	**(a)** deal with the impact of misunderstanding and fear of the unknown	Common theme.
6	**(b)** intimate and ironic	He addresses them.
7	**(d)** guide setting and action	Directions.
8	**(a)** humanistic	Humanistic.
9	**(d)** light-hearted satire	Satire.
10	**(c)** optimistic about peace	Optimism.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Decisions made on partial knowledge can be harmful (1) so leaders must verify facts and consult experts (1).	1+1
12	The Martians see culture as a source of strength (1) implying that a civilisation's stories may protect it as much as weapons (1).	1+1
13	They are comic outsiders mirroring human faults (1) and their misunderstandings mirror ours, so the play invites us to examine ourselves (1).	1+1
14	Direct speech and action allow quick humour (1) and the Historian's direct address links the audience to the events (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Nursery rhymes are imaginative nonsense. The Martians treat imagination as fact. The play shows that failing to distinguish them has consequences.	1+1+1
16	Think-Tank ordered Noodle to bring the book to him at once. The imperative is reported using 'ordered ... to'.	1+1+1
17	The title promises a heroic book. We find a nursery rhyme book saves the planet by accident. The gap between expectation and reality is ironic.	1+1+1
	OR: Both overestimate their abilities and misuse power. The Martians' arrogance is comic and harmless in the end; Griffin's is harmful. Both warn against pride without wisdom.	1+1+1
18	Frightened, the Martians retreated. A participial phrase joins the two.	1+1+1
	OR: He plans an invasion, so he is a villain in intent. But his comic errors make him a fool. The play treats him as a harmless fool whose pride is mocked.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Think-Tank's authority (1). Subordinates' obedience (1). Silly decisions (1). Humour and critique (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: State view (1). Convenient coincidence (1). Comic convention (1). Message not undermined (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Characters (1). Setting (1). Misreading (1). Humour (1). Resolution (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Invasion avoided (1). The Historian's closing note (1). Friendship later (1). Satire of conquest (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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